ENG-0002 Incident Postmortem: INC-059

Impact

The incident identified as INC-059 resulted in a Sev1 classification, indicating a critical impact on the auth-worker system (SYS-004). Given the high criticality of auth-worker within Project Juniper, the disruption affected core authentication functionalities, potentially impacting multiple dependent services and user access. The resolution time was 4.5 hours, during which service availability was compromised, leading to operational delays and potential user dissatisfaction. The incident underscored the importance of maintaining system stability, especially for systems integral to project operations.

Timeline

- **2025-04-08:** The incident was reported by Jamie Arnold, Head of Data & Analytics, indicating a critical failure in the auth-worker system.
- **Immediately following report:** Crystal Robinson, Project Manager and on-call engineer, was mobilized to address the issue.
- **Incident Response Duration:** The resolution process lasted approximately 4.5 hours.
- **Resolution:** The root cause was identified as a configuration change, which was subsequently reverted or corrected to restore system functionality.
- **Post-resolution:** System stability was confirmed, and normal operations resumed.

Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was categorized under a configuration change. This change was likely introduced within the auth-worker system, which is built on a Node.js/Express/MongoDB tech stack, and is owned by Project Juniper (P-011). The change was not adequately tested or validated prior to deployment, leading to system disruption. The incident highlights the risks associated with configuration modifications without sufficient safeguards or review processes.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Review and reinforce change management procedures for configuration updates in auth-worker	Project Juniper Lead (E-090)	ASAP	Ensure all configuration changes undergo thorough review and testing before deployment.
Implement additional validation and rollback mechanisms for configuration changes	DevOps Team	Within 2 weeks	To minimize impact of future configuration errors.
	Project Juniper Management	Within 1 week	Identify gaps and improve protocols.

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Conduct a post-incident review of the change process involving Crystal Robinson and relevant stakeholders			
Provide refresher training on change management policies for all team members involved in system updates	HR/Training Department	Within 3 weeks	Enhance awareness and adherence to best practices.
Monitor auth-worker system closely for stability over the next month	On-call Engineering Team	Ongoing	Detect and address any anomalies early.

Conclusion

The incident INC-059 on 2025-04-08, caused by a configuration change, underscores the critical importance of strict change management protocols, especially for high-criticality systems such as auth-worker. Crystal Robinson, who responded to the incident, played a key role in resolving the issue within 4.5 hours. Moving forward, the implementation of reinforced procedures and validation mechanisms will be prioritized to prevent recurrence and ensure system resilience for Project Juniper.